

Kunal Ninawe

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Full-stack Development | Frontend Development | Backend Development | Applied AI Engineering

Full-stack Software Engineer with 3+ years of experience building secure, scalable **identity-driven** systems in **production**. Proven ownership of **authentication**, **MFA**, & high-trust user workflows serving **100k+ users**, with strong debugging and reliability focus. Experienced in distributed systems, API design, testing, and production incident response in cloud environments.

CORE SKILLS

Frontend	TypeScript, React, Next.js , Jest, Cypress, State Management (<i>MobX</i>).
Backend	Node.js, Kotlin, Java , Spring Boot, REST & GraphQL APIs, gRPC, SQL
Cloud & DevOps	Docker, Kubernetes , CI/CD, AWS (<i>EC2</i> , <i>ECS</i> , <i>Lambda</i> , <i>S3</i>), Datadog
Identity & Security	OAuth 2.0, OIDC, JWTs, ACR levels, SSO, MFA , session management, token-based auth & Splunk.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Expedia Group, Seattle, WA | Software Engineer II May 2022 – Present

Unified Partner Account Management (Core Ownership)

- Unified fragmented B2B identity flows across partner and traveler systems by building **React**/TypeScript single page applications on **Node.js** (Hapi) and Java/**OIDC** services, enabling secure auth, MFA, email updates, and account management for **100k+ partners** on several EG Partner portals with **~90% feature adoption rate**.
- Designed update-email architecture across decoupled domains by defining REST/**GraphQL** contracts with centralized Identity services, modeling email as a shared identity attribute, and implementing resilient synchronization logic, **resolving ~45%** of identity-related bugs and inconsistencies.
- Implemented **step-up MFA with ACR policies** for sensitive operations using OTP-based flows and risk-aware rules, released via feature flags with staged rollouts and clickstream analytics to balance security posture and UX.

Architecture & Scalability

- Owned production releases of identity services using Git-based **CI/CD** with Spinnaker and **Kubernetes**, operating scalable, distributed microservices across AWS and internal clusters.

Quality & Reliability

- Improved release reliability by monitoring golden metrics, expanding pre-release smoke tests to **92% coverage**, and enforcing high-quality releases via progressive deployments, feature flags, sidecars, and secure secret management.
- Served as **L3 identity SME**, investigating specific issues like stale profiles, duplicate accounts, and **partial migrations** and authoring RCAs & runbooks that reduced time-to-resolve and drove a **~20% drop in support requests**.

Product Innovation (Hackathon – AI Travel UX)

- Co-led a company **hackathon** project prototyping a React/TypeScript experience with *maps & carousel* for cultural events + *AI-assisted itineraries*, & collaborated with Product & XD to pitch traveler engagement & booking inspiration.

Global Traffic Technologies, Minneapolis, MN | Full Stack Engineer June 2021 – April 2022

- Built and deployed scalable backend APIs and batch workflows using **AWS Lambda**, *ECS*, and *API Gateway*, guided by design docs and cost-optimized architecture decisions.
- Reduced latency and operational costs** by automating infrastructure with *CloudFormation*, migrating workloads from *DynamoDb* to *ElastiCache*, and implementing an asynchronous logging pipeline with *Kinesis Firehose*, *S3*, and *CloudWatch*.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

[AI Travel Itinerary Planner](#) January 2026

Developing an **MCP** based **AI-powered** travel itinerary planner using **Next.js**, TypeScript, **Map** APIs, and **OpenAI**, to assist users in decision-making workflows, demonstrating **GenAI-driven UX** and rapid prototyping.

EDUCATION

New York University, New York, NY | Master of Science, Computer Engineering May 2021

Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Cloud Computing, Distributed Systems, Internet Protocols, Machine & Deep Learning.

University of Mumbai, Mumbai, India | Bachelor of Science, Computer and Information Science July 2019